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Series by **Network NUTS**

Tips & Tricks

1

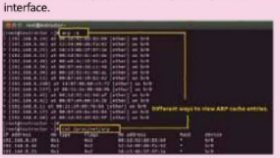
Do you know, while using TCP-Wrappers to control a service. You can tell the config files (/etc/hosts.allow or /etc/hosts.deny) to take the IP's from a file instead of mentioning there.
Can be very useful if you have got a large number of IP's.
Consider this example:
Edit – /etc/hosts.allow
vsftpd: /etc/myftp.hosts
–save and exit
Now create a file /etc/myftp.hosts and mention the IP's allowed, there in the file.
Edit – /etc/myftp.hosts
192.168.0.0/255.255.255.0

2

Though you have used the yum command. But, sometimes it can happen that you forget the exact name of the package you wish to install. Now it can be a difficult situation.
In these kind of cases you can use -
yum search keyword-for-the-package
It will give you a list of all the packages where that related term / word appears in the summary, name or description. Thus, making your life easy to pick your choice of package and install it.

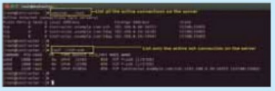
3

You know whenever you contact another machine either by using IP address or FQDN, its hardware address (MAC address) get mapped inside your machine using ARP (Address Resolution Protocol). You can view the current ARP cache using – arp -a command.
But there are couple of more methods to view the ARP cache. Like you can use:
cat /proc/net/arp
orip neighbor list
to view the same ARP cache entries.
Though need not to be done manually, as its been control by the Linux kernel (at this stage) you can, if you wish manually flush the ARP cache using:
ip neighbor flush dev eth0
command. Just replace eth0 with your respective interface.



4

You are managing your Linux server and now want to check who over the network is accessing your Linux server services.
You can use netstat or lsof command with ease to check that activity.
Here I have used the netstat command with --inet option to check the active connections.
Secondly, you can use the lsofcommand to check for particular type of active connections.
Here I have used the -i option to choose a particular type of network connection.
The -i option can be followed by an argument of the form [TCP|UDP][@host][:port] to select specific network connections any or all of the components can be omitted. For example, to view all ssh connections (which use TCP), to or from any machine:
#lsof -iTCP:ssh



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Network NUTS

Corporate Office - South Delhi A-184, Sukhdev Market, Bhism Pitamaha Road, Kotla Mubarakpur, New Delhi
Tel: 91-11-46526980/81/82 Contact Person: Shivani Sharma Mob: +91-9310024501 • **Branch Office: Preet Vihar**

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